Ear problems	Image	Symtoms and treatment
1. ***Swimmer's ear:*** develops when humidity, heat and moisture cause the skin layer inside the ear to swell. The addition of further water, for example, through swimming, makes the skin lining the ear canal even softer and liable to infection.		• Attempts to remove the water with cotton buds or other objects may make the condition worse, causing pain and itching. • Ear drops as prescribed.

5.8.3 Preventing ear problems

Self-management of ear problems, particularly earache and ear discharge, is not recommended. However, the following tips may help prevent ear problems.

- Do not use cotton buds or other devices for cleaning your ears. Repeated attempts to remove earwax with a cotton bud or similar object may result in the wax becoming more deeply impacted.
- If the patient has swimmer's ear, he should use earplugs to help prevent water entering your ears.
- If the patient is working in a noisy environment, including a home environment, ***use ear protectors.***
- Blow the nose correctly. Do not squeeze the nose when blowing and do not sniff.
- It is important that any hearing loss should be checked.

Highlights.

Cerumen is the proper name for ear wax, a substance that the human body naturally produces. Ear wax contains long-chain fatty acids, both unsaturated and saturated, as well as cholesterol, squalene, and alcohols.

Fact

Hearing impairment in a child is sometimes suspected if the child is inattentive at school, does not respond to instructions, seems to be disobedient or wants the television to be loud.

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